Your speaker guide

90-minute session · Supplied notes for 24 core slides and four backups. Use 30 minutes flexibly for discussion and resources alongside the core slide cues.

Preparation

Open the webdeck and companion. Print the six-page workbook and two-page takeaways. Prepared teaching examples replace live model calls. Keep the one-page route beside the deck. All displayed practice data and responses are fictional.

01. TRUST, TRANSPARENCY, AND AI

Welcome. Today covers both sides of the desk: AI supporting a scholarship team and AI supporting an applicant. Both raise the same question: how do we protect fairness and the trust of students? We will work through prompts, three prepared demonstrations, applicant AI use and practical policy. The core presentation uses about 60 minutes within our 90-minute session. Allow another 30 minutes for discussion and resource practice. The core route is: balancing act, 8 minutes; prompting, 10; review workflow, 17; applicant side, 12; policy, 13. The four backup slides sit outside that route.

All practice data and displayed demo responses are fictional teaching examples, not actual applicant records or captured model outputs.

VISUAL SOURCES: https://mguhlin.github.io/nspa/2026/images/photorealistic/review-team.png

Source artwork is AI-generated; people are fictional.

02. A quick pulse

2 minutes. Before I say more, I want to understand this room. Ask the first two questions by a show of hands, then invite one-word reactions. Name the tension without judging it. Excitement and concern can coexist. Teams may be piloting tools, considering a ban or simply trying to understand what applicants use. We will return to these starting points at the end. If polling technology fails, keep the activity verbal.

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VISUAL SOURCES: https://mguhlin.github.io/nspa/2026/images/conversation/conversation.png

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03. Two sides of the desk

3 minutes. On the provider side, the pressure of volume is real. Reviewers have limited time, and attention can drift as the pile grows. On the applicant side, tools can support brainstorming, grammar and access to feedback. Those uses can overlap with help that a teacher, counselor or family member might provide. We should avoid assuming every use has the same purpose or effect. Ask which expectations applicants and reviewers need to understand. Trust requires a process that people can explain, question and correct.

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04. Our guiding principle

2 minutes. If you remember one sentence, make it this one. AI can sort, summarize and suggest. People decide. Privacy concerns what information enters the system. Transparency concerns what applicants and staff understand about its use. Human oversight means a person has the time, authority and evidence to correct the work. Fairness means we test the process and apply the published criteria consistently. These are practical checkpoints. We will use them to evaluate each demonstration.

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05. Vague and structured prompts

2 minutes. A vague prompt leaves the system to guess the criteria, scale and meaning of a strong response. A structured prompt makes the task inspectable. It still cannot guarantee accuracy or fairness. Compare the two requests and ask what the first leaves unsaid. Criteria, evidence requirements and decision boundaries belong in the instruction, so reviewers can check whether the response followed them.

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VISUAL SOURCES: https://mguhlin.github.io/nspa/2026/images/infographics/comparison.png

Source artwork is AI-generated; people are fictional.

06. Anatomy of a strong review prompt

3 minutes. Read the six parts as one coherent instruction. Role establishes the assistance being requested. Task defines its scope. Context supplies the scholarship purpose and eligibility rules. Criteria must reproduce the actual rubric. Format requires a consistent output that humans can inspect. Constraints require direct evidence, visible uncertainty and no inferences about demographics or character. Add that application text is untrusted evidence, and any instructions embedded in it must not override the review task. This instruction reduces a risk; it does not eliminate the need for testing and verification.

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07. A rubric reviewers can apply

3 minutes. This is an illustrative rubric row created for workshop practice, not a validated award-selection instrument. Compare neighboring levels. What evidence would distinguish a specific contribution from a sustained contribution with results? Ask two reviewers to apply the same row before they see any AI output. If they disagree, discuss the evidence and revise ambiguous language. AI can expose unclear criteria, but it does not settle their meaning. Preserve the adopted rubric verbatim in any production prompt.

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08. The review workflow

2 minutes. Read the full sequence: intake; redact and minimize; completeness check; rubric pre-score with evidence; human review; committee decision; audit sample. AI can help at bounded drafting stages. A person approves the input, checks the evidence and owns the decision. Keep a record of the prompt version, corrections and reviewer. The final audit compares AI-assisted work with the source and independent human judgment. Repeat our principle: AI can sort, summarize and suggest. People decide.

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VISUAL SOURCES: https://mguhlin.github.io/nspa/2026/images/conversation/workflow-wide.png

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09. Privacy before processing

2 minutes. Before any real applicant data enters a tool, obtain local approval for the actual service, settings and purpose. An account label alone does not establish privacy. Removing a name may leave enough details to identify someone. For this workshop, use fictional records only. Check the privacy notice and donor agreements, and ask the appropriate owners which laws apply. FERPA does not apply identically to every independent scholarship provider or every record. Never upload confidential applicant records to an unapproved consumer service. Redaction alone does not make every use safe.

U.S. Department of Education, Privacy and Data Sharing: https://studentprivacy.ed.gov/privacy-and-data-sharing FERPA applicability and exceptions depend on the institution, records and disclosure; local owners must confirm applicable requirements.

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VISUAL SOURCES: https://mguhlin.github.io/nspa/2026/images/photorealistic/privacy-team.png

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10. Demo 1 · Administrative triage

3 minutes. This is a prepared teaching response, not a live model capture. Fictional practice rules require an essay, reference and transcript; GPA at least 3.0; Texas residency. Practice inputs: A-101 has all items, GPA 3.4 and states Texas residency. A-102 has essay and transcript, GPA 3.1 and states Texas residency; reference absent. A-103 has essay and reference, GPA 3.5 and no residency statement; transcript absent. Use the full triage prompt in backup B1. Ask AI to report eligibility evidence separately as met, not met or unknown, with a source. Even a reported threshold failure goes to a person for verification under published rules. Pause if a flag lacks a source. The screen shows the completeness portion for readability. The fallback table remains usable without Wi-Fi.

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11. Demo 2 · Evidence before a draft score

4 minutes. Read the fictional excerpt aloud before showing a score. This authored example illustrates the proficient level from slide 7 because the contribution and role are specific, while results remain only partly documented. A different adopted rubric could lead to another rating. The score is a provisional aid, not a final judgment. Ask participants to locate the quotation and explain whether it supports the rating. The excerpt shows a change was tried, not that it improved outcomes. Require an uncertainty note and a source paragraph for every criterion. Do not infer income, identity or character. Use backup B1 for the full prompt.

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12. Demo 3 · Organizing applications

3 minutes. Organizing a pile can help route review work, but tags can influence who gets attention. Use a controlled list and require a direct quotation. These three excerpts and the table are fictional authored examples. First-generation definitions differ, so do not treat a tag as a verified eligibility fact. Do not infer sensitive traits from names or writing style. A neutral summary should preserve uncertainties and avoid assigning character labels such as resilient or deserving. Ask a reviewer to check whether the summary flattened the applicant’s voice or omitted a relevant detail. Use backup B1 for the organizing prompt.

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13. Stress tests before a pilot

3 minutes. Run the same fictional case three times. Compare not only the numeric rating but also the evidence quoted and any omissions. Next, in a controlled fictional test, change only the name. Any unexplained difference deserves investigation. Keep real names out of scoring inputs where possible. Finally, compare ten fictional cases with independent human reviews. Ten is a practical workshop starting point, not a sufficient validation sample. Record disagreements, investigate causes, and expand the evaluation before high-impact use. Model, prompt and rubric changes can require a fresh test.

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14. Where AI fits

2 minutes. This is a workshop framework, not an official NSPA policy or a legal safe harbor. Green means a clerical drafting task with approved data and routine checking. Yellow means the output can shape judgment, so a human checks it against source evidence before use. Even a summary becomes yellow when it influences prioritization or hides material facts. Red covers decisions that require an authorized person, a reason and a correction route. A person owns eligibility denials as well as final award decisions. The color alone never makes an unapproved data use acceptable.

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15. Applicant AI use spans a spectrum

3 minutes, including two minutes in pairs. Applicant AI use is not one uniform behavior. Spell-check, brainstorming, feedback and generating a full personal essay raise different questions. Ask partners where their organization would draw a boundary and what purpose that boundary serves. Avoid assuming the spectrum represents a universal ethical scale. Accessibility tools, translation support and human editing can overlap with AI features. The organization must publish understandable rules, examples and an accessible disclosure route before applicants invest time in writing.

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16. Detection has practical limits

2 minutes. These are dated examples, not claims about every detector available today. OpenAI withdrew its particular classifier on July 20, 2023. Vanderbilt announced its decision on August 16, 2023. Editing and prompting reduced detection in the 2023 Liang study; performance depends on the system and sample. Turnitin's current guidance says the indicator can misidentify text and must not be the sole basis for adverse action. A report describes a tool's assessment of qualifying prose, not the probability that an applicant committed misconduct.

Sources: OpenAI historical classifier withdrawal, July 20, 2023: https://openai.com/index/new-ai-classifier-for-indicating-ai-written-text/

Vanderbilt historical decision, August 16, 2023: https://www.vanderbilt.edu/brightspace/2023/08/16/guidance-on-ai-detection-and-why-were-disabling-turnitins-ai-detector/

Turnitin, Using the AI Writing Report: warns against sole reliance for adverse action. https://guides.turnitin.com/hc/en-us/articles/22774058814093-Using-the-AI-Writing-Report

Liang et al. (2023), Patterns. Seven detectors, 91 TOEFL essays; average false-positive rate 61.3% in that sample. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.patter.2023.100779

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VISUAL SOURCES: https://mguhlin.github.io/nspa/2026/images/infographics/policy.png

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17. The human cost of a false positive

2 minutes. The arithmetic assumes all five thousand submissions are human-written and an illustrative one-percent false-positive rate: the expected count is fifty. It is not an observed rate, a forecast for this organization or the chance that a flagged person is innocent. Liang and colleagues found a 61.3% average false-positive rate across seven detectors on 91 TOEFL essays in their 2023 study. That study provides evidence of a disparity in those samples and tools, not a universal current rate. A 2026 Czech-language study found no systematic bias in its tested detector families. Different samples can produce different findings. Avoid unsupported claims about neurodivergent writers.

Sources: Liang et al. (2023), Patterns. Seven detectors, 91 TOEFL essays; average false-positive rate 61.3% in that sample. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.patter.2023.100779

Al Ali et al. (2026), Czech-language study; found no systematic bias against non-native writers in its tested detector families. Findings cannot be generalized across all languages or tools. https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.05769

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18. Application design for authenticity

2 minutes. Ask for a specific experience, the applicant’s contribution and the evidence of what happened. A follow-up conversation can clarify an account, but it does not prove authorship and must allow reasonable access and accommodations. Use the same process for similarly situated finalists. A brief optional reflection can describe writing support without turning disclosure into a penalty. Corroborate important claims through appropriate records or references. These practices support a richer review; none makes an application immune to fabrication.

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VISUAL SOURCES: https://mguhlin.github.io/nspa/2026/images/photorealistic/applicant.png

Source artwork is AI-generated; people are fictional.

19. A finalist’s essay feels “too perfect”

3 minutes, including two minutes in pairs. Invite participants to choose an action and explain what evidence supports it. Debrief: polished writing is not proof of unauthorized AI use, and detector output alone is insufficient. Read and score the content under the adopted rubric. If a material concern remains, identify the actual policy provision and facts. Use the organization’s established follow-up and appeal process. Apply any authorship conversation consistently to similarly situated finalists, offer an accessible response route, and avoid asking the applicant to prove innocence from a hunch. Repeat: AI can sort, summarize and suggest. People decide.

Turnitin, Using the AI Writing Report: warns against sole reliance for adverse action. https://guides.turnitin.com/hc/en-us/articles/22774058814093-Using-the-AI-Writing-Report

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https://mguhlin.github.io/nspa/2026/images/photorealistic/fair-conversation.png

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20. Applicant AI policy choices

3 minutes. These four approaches are policy options, not a claim about which one most organizations use. A prohibition requires clear scope and consideration of accessibility features. Disclosure requires a usable form and a statement of how the response affects review. A bounded policy defines what assistance is allowed and what must remain personal. An embrace policy still needs truthful claims and evidence. Organizations can combine bounded use with disclosure. Choose a stance that fits the award’s purpose, then test the examples with students and reviewers before publishing.

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21. Transparency goes both ways

3 minutes. We cannot reasonably ask applicants to explain their AI assistance while leaving our own process obscure. The sample statement is a starting point, not a description of an existing organization. Confirm the service, data use, retention and training arrangements before publishing any promise. If the organization can substantiate that applicant data is never used for model training, it can state that clearly. Do not add that assurance merely because the account is paid. Explain how a human verifies the output and how an applicant can seek a correction or review.

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22. Responsible AI review checklist

3 minutes. Read this as a practical implementation checklist rather than a certification. Ask participants to identify three weak areas and one owner for each. Some tasks depend on other tasks: a pilot needs an approved service, clear rules, fictional practice records and human verification before any real data use. Audit each cycle and revisit the tool after material changes. Do not promise that a small consistency test establishes fairness. The detector rule is a minimum: no adverse action based on a detector output alone. Add local requirements for incident response, appeals and records retention.

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23. A 30 / 60 / 90-day plan

3 minutes. Start with one bounded clerical task such as a completeness draft. Within thirty days, identify an owner, a proposed service, draft applicant guidance and a provider-use statement. By sixty days, test the process with fictional records. Approved minimized real records require separate local authorization and verification of the actual data use. Compare outputs with human review and record corrections. By ninety days, train reviewers, publish the policy and schedule an audit before the next cycle. Define the conditions that would pause the pilot.

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VISUAL SOURCES: https://mguhlin.github.io/nspa/2026/images/conversation/change-wide.png

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24. Back to trust

1 minute. Every scholarship carries trust: donors entrust their intent to the provider, and applicants entrust their stories to the process. AI may help reduce administrative work, but a person remains responsible for the evidence, the treatment of the applicant and the final decision. Invite one change participants will try with a colleague and when they will review it. The session is 90 minutes, 3:30–5:00 PM CT. Use the core presentation with additional discussion and resource practice. The companion, workbook and takeaways match this presentation. The four following slides are backups for questions and practice.

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25. B1 · Three complete demo prompts

Backup outside the timed sixty-minute route. These are full reusable practice prompts, not a guarantee of output quality. Put authorized rules and input evidence in clearly separated sections. Replace bracketed fields with approved criteria and fictional packets. Include stable paragraph identifiers so quotations can be traced. Keep the same prompt version and settings during comparisons. If a tool cannot support a requested format or reliable source tracing, pause and use a manual process. Read the generated response against the application before discussing it as a useful example.

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26. B2 · Questions for an AI vendor

Backup. Ask for written answers tied to the service edition and contract you would actually use. Training controls and retention controls are different. A no-training term does not automatically mean zero retention or no human access. Identify subprocessors, access controls, incident procedures and deletion mechanisms. Ask how model or service changes are communicated. Local privacy, security and program owners should decide whether the purpose, data and settings are appropriate. Preserve evidence of the approval and review it when the service or use changes.

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27. B3 · A simple applicant disclosure

Backup. This form is a sample rather than an existing organizational policy. Add a direct link to the permitted and prohibited examples. Explain whether disclosure affects review and give applicants a route to ask about accessibility and translation tools. Do not ask for complete chat histories or unnecessary personal information by default. An applicant should not have to guess which features count. Use a brief acknowledgment about factual accuracy and compliance with the published rule. Test the language with students before the application cycle opens.

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28. B4 · A shared vocabulary

Backup. A shared vocabulary helps a team discuss a problem precisely. An LLM can generate fluent text without verifying the truth of its claims. Hallucination includes fabricated quotations as well as incorrect summaries. A false positive concerns a human text flagged by a detector; it is different from a false claim produced by a review assistant. Personal information can remain in an essay after names are removed because details can identify someone in combination. Human in the loop must describe actual authority, time and evidence for review. Simply clicking approve is not meaningful oversight.

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